33 "So when it comes to pass—and surely it will come—then they will know that
a prophet has been among them."

34 Then the word of the LORD came to me, saying, 2 "Son of man, prophesy
against the shepherds of Israel. Prophesy and tell them that this is what the Lord
GOD says: 'Woe to the shepherds of Israel, who only feed themselves! Should
not the shepherds feed their flock?'" 3 You eat the fat, wear the wool, and butcher
the fattened sheep, but you do not feed the flock. 4 You have not strengthened
the weak, healed the sick, bound up the injured, brought back the strays, or
searched for the lost. Instead, you have ruled them with violence and cruelty.
5 They were scattered for lack of a shepherd, and when they were scattered they
became food for all the wild beasts. 6 My flock went astray on all the mountains
and every high hill. They were scattered over the face of all the earth, with no
one to search for them or seek them out.' 7 Therefore, you shepherds, hear the
word of the LORD: 8 'As surely as I live, declares the Lord GOD, because My
flock lacks a shepherd and has become prey and food for every wild beast, and
because My shepherds did not search for My flock but fed themselves instead,'
9 therefore, you shepherds, hear the word of the LORD!'

10 This is what the Lord GOD says: 'Behold, I am against the shepherds, and
I will demand from them My flock and remove them from tending the flock, so
that they can no longer feed themselves. For I will deliver My flock from their
mouths, and it will no longer be food for them.' 11 For this is what the Lord
GOD says: 'Behold, I Myself will search for My flock and seek them out.' 12 As a
shepherd looks for his scattered sheep when he is among the flock, so I will look
for My flock. I will rescue them from all the places to which they were scattered
on a day of clouds and darkness. 13 I will bring them out from the peoples, gather
them from the countries, and bring them into their own land. I will feed them
on the mountains of Israel, in the ravines, and in all the settlements of the land.

14 I will feed them in good pasture, and the lofty mountains of Israel will be their
grazing land. There they will lie down in a good grazing land; they will feed in
rich pasture on the mountains of Israel. 15 I will tend My flock and make them
lie down, declares the Lord GOD. 16 I will seek the lost, bring back the strays,
bind up the broken, and strengthen the weak; but the sleek and strong I will
destroy. I will shepherd them with justice.' 17 This is what the Lord GOD says to
you, My flock: 'I will judge between one sheep and another, between the rams
and the goats.' 18 Is it not enough for you to feed on the good pasture? Must
you also trample the rest of the pasture with your feet? Is it not enough for you
to drink the clear waters? Must you also muddy the rest with your feet? 19 Why
must My flock feed on what your feet have trampled, and drink what your feet
have muddied?'

20 Therefore this is what the Lord GOD says to them: 'Behold, I Myself will
judge between the fat sheep and the lean sheep.' 21 Since you shove with flank
and shoulder, butting all the weak ones with your horns until you have scattered
them abroad, 22 I will save My flock, and they will no longer be prey. I will judge
between one sheep and another. 23 I will appoint over them one shepherd, My
servant David, and he will feed them. He will feed them and be their shepherd.
24 I, the LORD, will be their God, and My servant David will be a prince
among them. I, the LORD, have spoken. 25 I will make with them a covenant
of peace and rid the land of wild animals, so that they may dwell securely in the
wilderness and sleep in the forest. 26 I will make them and the places around My
hill a blessing. I will send down showers in season—showers of blessing. 27 The
trees of the field will give their fruit, and the land will yield its produce; My
flock will be secure in their land. Then they will know that I am the LORD,
when I have broken the bars of their yoke and delivered them from the hands
that enslaved them. 28 They will no longer be prey for the nations, and the beasts
of the earth will not consume them. They will dwell securely, and no one will
frighten them. 29 And I will raise up for them a garden of renown, and they will no
longer be victims of famine in the land or bear the scorn of the nations. 30 Then
they will know that I, the LORD their God, am with them, and that they, the
house of Israel, are My people,' declares the Lord GOD. 31 "'You are My flock, the
sheep of My pasture, My people, and I am your God,' declares the Lord GOD."

35 Moreover, the word of the LORD came to me, saying, 2 "Son of man,
set your face against Mount Seir and prophesy against it," 3 and declare that this
is what the Lord GOD says: Behold, I am against you, O Mount Seir. I will
stretch out My hand against you and make you a desolate waste. 4 I will turn
your cities into ruins, and you will become a desolation. Then you will know
that I am the LORD. 5 Because you harbored an ancient hatred and delivered
the Israelites over to the sword in the time of their disaster at the final stage of
their punishment, 6 therefore as surely as I live, declares the Lord GOD, I will give
you over to bloodshed and it will pursue you. Since you did not hate bloodshed,
it will pursue you. 7 I will make Mount Seir a desolate waste and will cut off from
it those who come and go.

8 I will fill its mountains with the slain; those killed by the sword will fall on
your hills, in your valleys, and in all your ravines. 9 I will make you a perpetual
desolation, and your cities will not be inhabited. Then you will know that I am
the LORD. 10 Because you have said, 'These two nations and countries will be
ours, and we will possess them,' even though the LORD was there, 11 therefore
as surely as I live, declares the Lord GOD, I will treat you according to the anger
and jealousy you showed in your hatred against them, and I will make Myself
known among them when I judge you. 12 Then you will know that I, the LORD,
have heard every contemptuous word you uttered against the mountains of Israel
when you said, 'They are desolate; they are given to us to devour!' 13 You boasted
against Me with your mouth and multiplied your words against Me. I heard
it Myself! 14 This is what the Lord GOD says: While the whole earth rejoices,
I will make you desolate. 15 As you rejoiced when the inheritance of the house
of Israel became desolate, so will I do to you. You will become a desolation, O
Mount Seir, and so will all of Edom. Then they will know that I am the LORD.

36 "And you, son of man, prophesy to the mountains of Israel and say: O
mountains of Israel, hear the word of the LORD." 2 This is what the Lord GOD
says: Because the enemy has said of you, 'Aha! The ancient heights have become
our possession,' 3 therefore prophesy and declare that this is what the Lord GOD
says: Because they have made you desolate and have trampled you on every side,
so that you became a possession of the rest of the nations and were taken up in
slander by the lips of their talkers, 4 therefore, O mountains of Israel, hear the
word of the Lord GOD. This is what the Lord GOD says to the mountains
and hills, to the ravines and valleys, to the desolate ruins and abandoned cities,
which have become a spoil and a mockery to the rest of the nations around you.
5 Therefore this is what the Lord GOD says: Surely in My burning zeal I have
spoken against the rest of the nations, and against all Edom, who took My land
as their own possession with wholehearted joy and utter contempt, so that its
pastureland became plunder. 6 Therefore, prophesy concerning the land of Israel
and tell the mountains and hills, the ravines and valleys, that this is what the Lord
GOD says: Behold, I have spoken in My burning zeal because you have endured
the reproach of the nations. 7 Therefore this is what the Lord GOD says: I have
sworn with an uplifted hand that surely the nations around you will endure
reproach of their own. 8 But you, O mountains of Israel, will produce branches
and bear fruit for My people Israel, for they will soon come home. 9 For behold,
I am on your side; I will turn toward you, and you will be tilled and sown. 10 I
will multiply the people upon you—the house of Israel in its entirety. The cities
will be inhabited and the ruins rebuilt. 11 I will fill you with people and animals,
and they will multiply and be fruitful. I will make you as inhabited as you once
were, and I will make you prosper more than before. Then you will know that I
am the LORD.

12 Yes, I will cause My people Israel to walk upon you; they will possess
you, and you will be their inheritance, and you will no longer deprive them of
their children. 13 For this is what the Lord GOD says: Because people say to
you, 'You devour men and deprive your nation of its children,' 14 therefore you
will no longer devour men or deprive your nation of its children, declares the
Lord GOD. 15 "I will no longer allow the taunts of the nations to be heard against
you, and you will no longer endure the reproach of the peoples or cause your
nation to stumble, declares the Lord GOD." 16 Again the word of the LORD
came to me, saying, 17 "Son of man, when the people of Israel lived in their land,
they defiled it by their own ways and deeds. Their behavior before Me was like
the uncleanness of a woman's impurity." 18 So I poured out My wrath upon them
because of the blood they had shed on the land, and because they had defiled it
with their idols. 19 I dispersed them among the nations, and they were scattered
throughout the lands. I judged them according to their ways and deeds. 20 And
wherever they went among the nations, they profaned My holy name, because
it was said of them, 'These are the people of the LORD, yet they had to leave
His land.' 21 But I had concern for My holy name, which the house of Israel had
profaned among the nations to which they had gone. 22 Therefore tell the house
of Israel that this is what the Lord GOD says: It is not for your sake that I will act,
O house of Israel, but for My holy name, which you profaned among the nations
to which you went. 23 I will show the holiness of My great name, which has been
profaned among the nations—the name you have profaned among them. Then
the nations will know that I am the LORD, declares the Lord GOD, when I
show My holiness in you before their eyes.

24 For I will take you from among the nations and gather you out of all the
countries, and I will bring you back into your own land.

25 I will also sprinkle clean water on you, and you will be clean. I will cleanse you
from all your impurities and all your idols. 26 I will give you a new heart and put
a new spirit within you; I will remove your heart of stone and give you a heart
of flesh. 27 And I will put My Spirit within you and cause you to walk in My
statutes and to carefully observe My ordinances. 28 Then you will live in the land
that I gave your forefathers; you will be My people, and I will be your God.

29 I will save you from all your uncleanness. I will summon the grain and make
it plentiful, and I will not bring famine upon you. 30 I will also make the fruit
of the trees and the crops of the field plentiful, so that you will no longer bear
reproach among the nations on account of famine. 31 Then you will remember
your evil ways and wicked deeds, and you will loathe yourselves for your
iniquities and abominations. 32 It is not for your sake that I will act, declares the
Lord GOD—let it be known to you. Be ashamed and disgraced for your ways, O
house of Israel! 33 This is what the Lord GOD says: On the day I cleanse you from
all your iniquities, I will cause the cities to be resettled and the ruins to be rebuilt.
34 The desolate land will be cultivated instead of lying desolate in the sight of all
who pass through. 35 Then they will say, 'This land that was desolate has become
like the garden of Eden. The cities that were once ruined, desolate, and destroyed
are now fortified and inhabited.' 36 Then the nations around you that remain will
know that I, the LORD, have rebuilt what was destroyed, and I have replanted
what was desolate. I, the LORD, have spoken, and I will do it. 37 This is what the

Lord GOD says: Once again I will hear the plea of the house of Israel and do for them this: I will multiply their people like a flock. [38] "Like the numerous flocks for sacrifices at Jerusalem during her appointed feasts, so the ruined cities will be filled with flocks of people. Then they will know that I am the LORD."

37 The hand of the LORD was upon me, and He brought me out by His Spirit and set me down in the middle of the valley, and it was full of bones. [2] He led me all around among them, and I saw a great many bones on the floor of the valley, and indeed, they were very dry. [3] Then He asked me, "Son of man, can these bones come to life?" "O Lord GOD," I replied, "only You know." [4] And He said to me, "Prophesy concerning these bones and tell them, 'Dry bones, hear the word of the LORD!'" [5] This is what the Lord GOD says to these bones: I will cause breath to enter you, and you will come to life. [6] "I will attach tendons to you and make flesh grow upon you and cover you with skin. I will put breath within you so that you will come to life. Then you will know that I am the LORD.'" [7] So I prophesied as I had been commanded. And as I prophesied, there was suddenly a noise, a rattling, and the bones came together, bone to bone. [8] As I looked on, tendons appeared on them, flesh grew, and skin covered them; but there was no breath in them.

[9] Then He said to me, "Prophesy to the breath; prophesy, son of man, and tell the breath that this is what the Lord GOD says: Come from the four winds, O breath, and breathe into these slain, so that they may live!" [10] So I prophesied as He had commanded me, and the breath entered them, and they came to life and stood on their feet—a vast army. [11] Then He said to me, "Son of man, these bones are the whole house of Israel. Look, they are saying, 'Our bones are dried up, and our hope has perished; we are cut off.'" [12] Therefore prophesy and tell them that this is what the Lord GOD says: 'O My people, I will open your graves and bring you up from them, and I will bring you back to the land of Israel.'

[13] Then you, My people, will know that I am the LORD, when I open your graves and bring you up from them. [14] "I will put My Spirit in you and you will live, and I will settle you in your own land. Then you will know that I, the LORD, have spoken, and I will do it, declares the LORD.'" [15] Again the word of the LORD came to me, saying, [16] "And you, son of man, take a single stick and write on it: 'Belonging to Judah and to the Israelites associated with him.' Then take another stick and write on it: 'Belonging to Joseph—the stick of Ephraim —and to all the house of Israel associated with him.'" [17] Then join them together into one stick, so that they become one in your hand.

[18] When your people ask you, 'Won't you explain to us what you mean by these?' [19] you are to tell them that this is what the Lord GOD says: 'I will take the stick of Joseph, which is in the hand of Ephraim, and the tribes of Israel associated with him, and I will put them together with the stick of Judah. I will make them into a single stick, and they will become one in My hand.' [20] When the sticks on which you write are in your hand and in full view of the people, [21] you are to tell them that this is what the Lord GOD says: 'I will take the Israelites out of the nations to which they have gone, and I will gather them from all around and bring them into their own land.' [22] I will make them one nation in the land, on the mountains of Israel, and one king will rule over all of them. Then they will no longer be two nations and will never again be divided into two kingdoms. [23] They will no longer defile themselves with their idols or detestable images, or with any of their transgressions. I will save them from all their apostasies by which they sinned, and I will cleanse them. Then they will be My people, and I will be their God. [24] My servant David will be king over them, and there will be one shepherd for all of them. They will follow My ordinances and keep and observe My statutes. [25] They will live in the land that I gave to My servant Jacob, where your fathers lived. They will live there forever with their children and grandchildren, and My servant David will be their prince forever. [26] And I will make a covenant of peace with them; it will be an everlasting covenant. I will establish them and multiply them, and I will set My sanctuary among them forever. [27] My dwelling place will be with them; I will be their God, and they will be My people. [28] "Then the nations will know that I the LORD sanctify Israel, when My sanctuary is among them forever.'"

38 And the word of the LORD came to me, saying, [2] "Son of man, set your face against Gog of the land of Magog, the chief prince of Meshech and Tubal. Prophesy against him" [3] and declare that this is what the Lord GOD says: Behold, I am against you, O Gog, chief prince of Meshech and Tubal. [4] I will turn you around, put hooks in your jaws, and bring you out with all your army—your horses, your horsemen in full armor, and a great company armed with shields and bucklers, all brandishing their swords. [5] Persia, Cush, and Put will accompany them, all with shields and helmets, [6] as well as Gomer with all its troops, and Beth-togarmah from the far north with all its troops—the many nations with you.

[7] Get ready; prepare yourself, you and all your company gathered around you; you will be their guard. [8] After a long time you will be summoned. In the latter years you will enter a land that has recovered from war, whose people were gathered from many nations to the mountains of Israel, which had long been desolate. They had been brought out from the nations, and all now dwell securely. [9] You and all your troops, and many peoples with you will go up, advancing like a thunderstorm; you will be like a cloud covering the land.

[10] This is what the Lord GOD says: On that day, thoughts will arise in your mind, and you will devise an evil plan. [11] You will say, 'I will go up against a land of unwalled villages; I will come against a tranquil people who dwell securely, all of them living without walls or bars or gates—' [12] in order to seize the spoil and carry off the plunder, to turn a hand against the desolate places now inhabited and against a people gathered from the nations, who have acquired livestock and possessions and who live at the center of the land.' [13] Sheba and Dedan and the merchants of Tarshish with all its villages will ask, 'Have you come to capture the plunder? Have you assembled your hordes to carry away loot, to make off with silver and gold, to take cattle and goods, to seize great spoil?' [14] Therefore prophesy, son of man, and tell Gog that this is what the Lord GOD says: On that day when My people Israel are dwelling securely, will you not take notice of this?

[15] And you will come from your place out of the far north—you and many peoples with you, all riding horses—a mighty horde, a huge army. [16] You will advance against My people Israel like a cloud covering the land. It will happen in the latter days, O Gog, that I will bring you against My land, so that the nations may know Me when I show Myself holy in you before their eyes. [17] This is what the Lord GOD says: Are you the one of whom I have spoken in former days through My servants, the prophets of Israel, who in those times prophesied for years that I would bring you against them? [18] Now on that day when Gog comes against the land of Israel, declares the Lord GOD, My wrath will flare up. [19] In My zeal and fiery rage I proclaim that on that day there will be a great earthquake in the land of Israel. [20] The fish of the sea, the birds of the air, the beasts of the field, every creature that crawls upon the ground, and all mankind on the face of the earth will tremble at My presence. The mountains will be thrown down, the cliffs will collapse, and every wall will fall to the ground. [21] And I will summon a sword against Gog on all My mountains, declares the Lord GOD, and every man's sword will be against his brother. [22] I will execute judgment upon him with plague and bloodshed. I will pour out torrents of rain, hailstones, fire, and sulfur on him and on his troops and on the many nations with him. [23] I will magnify and sanctify Myself, and will reveal Myself in the sight of many nations. Then they will know that I am the LORD.

39 "As for you, O son of man, prophesy against Gog and declare that this is what the Lord GOD says: Behold, I am against you, O Gog, chief prince of Meshech and Tubal." [2] I will turn you around, drive you along, bring you up from the far north, and send you against the mountains of Israel. [3] Then I will strike the bow from your left hand and dash down the arrows from your right hand. [4] On the mountains of Israel you will fall—you and all your troops and the nations with you. I will give you as food to every kind of ravenous bird and wild beast. [5] You will fall in the open field, for I have spoken, declares the Lord GOD. [6] I will send fire on Magog and on those who dwell securely in the coastlands, and they will know that I am the LORD. [7] So I will make My holy name known among My people Israel and will no longer allow it to be profaned. Then the nations will know that I am the LORD, the Holy One in Israel. [8] Yes, it is coming, and it will surely happen, declares the Lord GOD. This is the day of which I have spoken.

[9] Then those who dwell in the cities of Israel will go out, kindle fires, and burn up the weapons—the bucklers and shields, the bows and arrows, the clubs and spears. For seven years they will use them for fuel. [10] They will not gather wood from the countryside or cut it from the forests, for they will use the weapons for fuel. They will loot those who looted them and plunder those who plundered them, declares the Lord GOD. [11] And on that day I will give Gog a burial place in Israel, the Valley of the Travelers, east of the Sea. It will block those who travel through, because Gog and all his hordes will be buried there. So it will be called the Valley of Hamon-gog. [12] For seven months the house of Israel will be burying them in order to cleanse the land. [13] All the people of the land will bury them, and it will bring them renown on the day I display My glory, declares the Lord GOD.

[14] And men will be employed to continually pass through the land to cleanse it by burying the invaders who remain on the ground. At the end of the seven months they will begin their search. [15] As they pass through the land, anyone who sees a human bone will set up a pillar next to it, until the gravediggers have buried it in the Valley of Hamon-gog. [16] (Even the city will be named Hamonah.) And so they will cleanse the land. [17] And as for you, son of man, this is what the Lord GOD says: Call out to every kind of bird and to every beast of the field: 'Assemble and come together from all around to the sacrificial feast that I am preparing for you, a great feast on the mountains of Israel. There you will eat flesh and drink blood.' [18] You will eat the flesh of the mighty and drink the blood of the princes of the earth as though they were rams, lambs, goats, and bulls—all the fattened animals of Bashan.

[19] At the sacrifice I am preparing, you will eat fat until you are gorged and drink blood until you are drunk. [20] And at My table you will eat your fill of horses and riders, of mighty men and warriors of every kind,' declares the Lord GOD. [21] I will display My glory among the nations, and all the nations will see the judgment that I execute and the hand that I lay upon them. [22] From that day forward the house of Israel will know that I am the LORD their God. [23] And the nations will know that the house of Israel went into exile for their iniquity, because they were unfaithful to Me. So I hid My face from them and delivered them into the hands of their enemies, so that they all fell by the sword. [24] I dealt with them according to their uncleanness and transgressions, and I hid My face from them. [25] Therefore this is what the Lord GOD says: Now I will restore Jacob from captivity and will have compassion on the whole house of Israel, and I will be jealous for My holy name. [26] They will forget their disgrace and all the treachery

they committed against Me, when they dwell securely in their land, with no one to frighten them. [27] When I bring them back from the peoples and gather them out of the lands of their enemies, I will show My holiness in them in the sight of many nations. [28] Then they will know that I am the LORD their God, when I regather them to their own land, not leaving any of them behind after their exile among the nations. [29] "And I will no longer hide My face from them, for I will pour out My Spirit on the house of Israel, declares the Lord GOD."

40 In the twenty-fifth year of our exile, at the beginning of the year, on the tenth day of the month—in the fourteenth year after Jerusalem had been struck down—on that very day the hand of the LORD was upon me, and He took me there. [2] In visions of God He took me to the land of Israel and set me on a very high mountain, on whose southern slope was a structure that resembled a city. [3] So He took me there, and I saw a man whose appearance was like bronze. He was standing in the gateway with a linen cord and a measuring rod in his hand. [4] "Son of man," he said to me, "look with your eyes, hear with your ears, and pay attention to everything I am going to show you, for that is why you have been brought here. Report to the house of Israel everything you see." [5] And I saw a wall surrounding the temple area. Now the length of the measuring rod in the man's hand was six long cubits (each measuring a cubit and a handbreadth), and he measured the wall to be one rod thick and one rod high. [6] Then he came to the gate facing east and climbed its steps. He measured the threshold of the gate to be one rod deep. [7] Each gate chamber was one rod long and one rod wide, and there were five cubits between the gate chambers. The inner threshold of the gate by the portico facing inward was one rod deep. [8] Then he measured the portico of the gateway inside; [9] it was eight cubits deep, and its jambs were two cubits thick. And the portico of the gateway faced the temple. [10] There were three gate chambers on each side of the east gate, each with the same measurements, and the gateposts on either side also had the same measurements. [11] And he measured the width of the gateway entrance to be ten cubits, and its length was thirteen cubits. [12] In front of each gate chamber was a wall one cubit high, and the gate chambers were six cubits square. [13] Then he measured the gateway from the roof of one gate chamber to the roof of the opposite one; the distance was twenty-five cubits from doorway to doorway. [14] Next he measured the gateposts to be sixty cubits high. The gateway extended around to the gatepost of the courtyard. [15] And the distance from the entrance of the gateway to the far end of its inner portico was fifty cubits.

[16] The gate chambers and their side pillars had beveled windows all around the inside of the gateway. The porticos also had windows all around on the inside. Each side pillar was decorated with palm trees. [17] Then he brought me into the outer court, and there were chambers and a pavement laid out all around the court. Thirty chambers faced the pavement, [18] which flanked the gateways and corresponded to the length of the gates; this was the lower pavement. [19] Then he measured the distance from the front of the lower gateway to the outside of the inner court; it was a hundred cubits on the east side as well as on the north. [20] He also measured the length and width of the gateway of the outer court facing north.

[21] Its three gate chambers on each side, its side pillars, and its portico all had the same measurements as the first gate: fifty cubits long and twenty-five cubits wide. [22] Its windows, portico, and palm trees had the same measurements as those of the gate facing east. Seven steps led up to it, with its portico opposite them. [23] There was a gate to the inner court facing the north gate, just as there was on the east. He measured the distance from gateway to gateway to be a hundred cubits. [24] Then he led me to the south side, and I saw a gateway facing south. He measured its side pillars and portico, and they had the same measurements as the others. [25] Both the gateway and its portico had windows all around, like the other windows. It was fifty cubits long and twenty-five cubits wide. [26] Seven steps led up to it, and its portico was opposite them; it had palm trees on its side pillars, one on each side. [27] The inner court also had a gate facing south, and he measured the distance from gateway to gateway toward the south to be a hundred cubits. [28] Next he brought me into the inner court through the south gate, and he measured the south gate; it had the same measurements as the others. [29] Its gate chambers, side pillars, and portico had the same measurements as the others. Both the gateway and its portico had windows all around; it was fifty cubits long and twenty-five cubits wide. [30] (The porticoes around the inner court were twenty-five cubits long and five cubits deep.) [31] Its portico faced the outer court, and its side pillars were decorated with palm trees. Eight steps led up to it.

[32] And he brought me to the inner court on the east side, and he measured the gateway; it had the same measurements as the others. [33] Its gate chambers, side pillars, and portico had the same measurements as the others. Both the gateway and its portico had windows all around. It was fifty cubits long and twenty-five cubits wide. [34] Its portico faced the outer court, and its side pillars were decorated with palm trees on each side. Eight steps led up to it. [35] Then he brought me to the north gate and measured it. It had the same measurements as the others, [36] as did its gate chambers, side pillars, and portico. It also had windows all around. It was fifty cubits long and twenty-five cubits wide. [37] Its portico faced the outer court, and its side pillars were decorated with palm trees on each side. Eight steps led up to it. [38] There was a chamber with a doorway by the portico in each of the inner gateways. There the burnt offering was to be washed. [39] Inside the portico of the gateway were two tables on each side, on which the burnt offerings, sin offerings, and guilt offerings were to be slaughtered. [40] Outside, as one goes up to the entrance of the north gateway, there were two tables on one side and two more tables on the other side of the gate's portico. [41] So there were four tables inside the gateway and four outside—eight tables in all—on which the sacrifices were to be slaughtered. [42] There were also four tables of dressed stone for the burnt offering, each a cubit and a half long, a cubit and a half wide, and a cubit high. On these were placed the utensils used to slaughter the burnt offerings and the other sacrifices. [43] The double-pronged hooks, each a handbreadth long, were fastened all around the inside of the room, and the flesh of the offering was to be placed on the tables. [44] Outside the inner gate, within the inner court, were two chambers, one beside the north gate and facing south, and another beside the south gate and facing north. [45] Then the man said to me: "The chamber that faces south is for the priests who keep charge of the temple," [46] "and the chamber that faces north is for the priests who keep charge of the altar. These are the sons of Zadok, the only Levites who may approach the LORD to minister before Him." [47] Next he measured the court. It was square, a hundred cubits long and a hundred cubits wide. And the altar was in front of the temple. [48] Then he brought me to the portico of the temple and measured the side pillars of the portico to be five cubits on each side. The width of the gateway was fourteen cubits and its sidewalls were three cubits on either side. [49] The portico was twenty cubits wide and twelve cubits deep, and ten steps led up to it. There were columns by the side pillars, one on each side.

41 Then the man brought me into the outer sanctuary and measured the side pillars to be six cubits wide on each side. [2] The width of the entrance was ten cubits, and the sides of the entrance were five cubits on each side. He also measured the length of the outer sanctuary to be forty cubits, and the width to be twenty cubits. [3] And he went into the inner sanctuary and measured the side pillars at the entrance to be two cubits wide. The entrance was six cubits wide, and the walls on each side were seven cubits wide. [4] Then he measured the room adjacent to the inner sanctuary to be twenty cubits long and twenty cubits wide. And he said to me, "This is the Most Holy Place." [5] Next he measured the wall of the temple to be six cubits thick, and the width of each side room around the temple was four cubits. [6] The side rooms were arranged one above another in three levels of thirty rooms each. There were ledges all around the wall of the temple to serve as supports for the side rooms, so that the supports would not be fastened into the wall of the temple itself. [7] The side rooms surrounding the temple widened at each successive level, because the structure surrounding the temple ascended by stages corresponding to the narrowing of the temple wall as it rose upward. And so a stairway went up from the lowest story to the highest, through the middle one.

[8] I saw that the temple had a raised base all around it, forming the foundation of the side rooms. It was the full length of a rod, six long cubits. [9] The outer wall of the side rooms was five cubits thick, and the open area between the side rooms of the temple [10] and the outer chambers was twenty cubits wide all around the temple. [11] The side rooms opened into this area, with one entrance on the north and another on the south. The open area was five cubits wide all around.

[12] Now the building that faced the temple courtyard on the west was seventy cubits wide, and the wall of the building was five cubits thick all around, with a length of ninety cubits. [13] Then he measured the temple to be a hundred cubits long, and the temple courtyard and the building with its walls were also a hundred cubits long. [14] The width of the temple courtyard on the east, including the front of the temple, was a hundred cubits. [15] Next he measured the length of the building facing the temple courtyard at the rear of the temple, including its galleries on each side; it was a hundred cubits. The outer sanctuary, the inner sanctuary, and the porticoes facing the court, [16] as well as the thresholds and the beveled windows and the galleries all around with their three levels opposite the threshold, were overlaid with wood on all sides. They were paneled from the ground to the windows, and the windows were covered.

[17] In the space above the outside of the entrance to the inner sanctuary on all the walls, spaced evenly around the inner and outer sanctuary, [18] were alternating carved cherubim and palm trees. Each cherub had two faces: [19] the face of a man was toward the palm tree on one side, and the face of a young lion was toward the palm tree on the other side. They were carved all the way around the temple. [20] Cherubim and palm trees were carved on the wall of the outer sanctuary from the floor to the space above the entrance. [21] The outer sanctuary had a rectangular doorframe, and the doorframe of the sanctuary was similar. [22] There was an altar of wood three cubits high and two cubits square. Its corners, base, and sides were of wood. And the man told me, "This is the table that is before the LORD." [23] Both the outer sanctuary and the inner sanctuary had double doors, [24] and each door had two swinging panels. There were two panels for one door and two for the other. [25] Cherubim and palm trees like those on the walls were carved on the doors of the outer sanctuary, and there was a wooden canopy outside, on the front of the portico. [26] There were beveled windows and palm trees on the sidewalls of the portico. The side rooms of the temple also had canopies.

42 Then the man led me out northward into the outer court, and he brought me to the group of chambers opposite the temple courtyard and the outer wall on the north side. [2] The building with the door facing north was a hundred cubits long and fifty cubits wide. [3] Gallery faced gallery in three levels opposite the twenty cubits that belonged to the inner court and opposite the pavement that belonged to the outer court. [4] In front of the chambers was an inner walkway

ten cubits wide and a hundred cubits long. Their doors were on the north. [5] Now the upper chambers were smaller because the galleries took more space from the chambers on the lower and middle floors of the building. [6] For they were arranged in three stories, and unlike the courts, they had no pillars. So the upper chambers were set back further than the lower and middle floors. [7] An outer wall in front of the chambers was fifty cubits long and ran parallel to the chambers and the outer court. [8] For the chambers on the outer court were fifty cubits long, while those facing the temple were a hundred cubits long. [9] And below these chambers was the entrance on the east side as one enters them from the outer court.

[10] On the south side along the length of the wall of the outer court were chambers adjoining the courtyard and opposite the building, [11] with a passageway in front of them, just like the chambers that were on the north. They had the same length and width, with similar exits and dimensions. [12] And corresponding to the doors of the chambers that were facing south, there was a door in front of the walkway that was parallel to the wall extending eastward. [13] Then the man said to me, "The north and south chambers facing the temple courtyard are the holy chambers where the priests who approach the LORD will eat the most holy offerings. There they will place the most holy offerings—the grain offerings, the sin offerings, and the guilt offerings—for the place is holy." [14] "Once the priests have entered the holy area, they must not go out into the outer court until they have left behind the garments in which they minister, for these are holy. They are to put on other clothes before they approach the places that are for the people." [15] Now when the man had finished measuring the interior of the temple area, he led me out by the gate that faced east, and he measured the area all around: [16] With a measuring rod he measured the east side to be five hundred cubits long. [17] He measured the north side to be five hundred cubits long. [18] He measured the south side to be five hundred cubits long. [19] And he came around and measured the west side to be five hundred cubits long. [20] So he measured the area on all four sides. It had a wall all around, five hundred cubits long and five hundred cubits wide, to separate the holy from the common.

43 Then the man brought me back to the gate that faces east, [2] and I saw the glory of the God of Israel coming from the east. His voice was like the roar of many waters, and the earth shone with His glory. [3] The vision I saw was like the vision I had seen when He came to destroy the city and like the visions I had seen by the River Kebar. I fell facedown, [4] and the glory of the LORD entered the temple through the gate facing east. [5] Then the Spirit lifted me up and brought me into the inner court, and the glory of the LORD filled the temple. [6] While the man was standing beside me, I heard someone speaking to me from inside the temple, [7] and He said to me, "Son of man, this is the place of My throne and the place for the soles of My feet, where I will dwell among the Israelites forever. The house of Israel will never again defile My holy name—neither they nor their kings—by their prostitution and by the funeral offerings for their kings at their deaths." [8] When they placed their threshold next to My threshold and their doorposts beside My doorposts, with only a wall between Me and them, they defiled My holy name by the abominations they committed. Therefore I have consumed them in My anger.

[9] Now let them remove far from Me their prostitution and the funeral offerings for their kings, and I will dwell among them forever. [10] As for you, son of man, describe the temple to the people of Israel, so that they may be ashamed of their iniquities. Let them measure the plan, [11] and if they are ashamed of all they have done, then make known to them the design of the temple—its arrangement and its exits and entrances—its whole design along with all its statutes, forms, and laws. Write it down in their sight, so that they may keep its complete design and all its statutes and may carry them out.

[12] This is the law of the temple: All its surrounding territory on top of the mountain will be most holy. Yes, this is the law of the temple. [13] These are the measurements of the altar in long cubits (a cubit and a handbreadth): Its gutter shall be a cubit deep and a cubit wide, with a rim of one span around its edge. And this is the height of the altar: [14] The space from the gutter on the ground to the lower ledge shall be two cubits, and the ledge one cubit wide. The space from the smaller ledge to the larger ledge shall be four cubits, and the ledge one cubit wide. [15] The altar hearth shall be four cubits high, and four horns shall project upward from the hearth. [16] The altar hearth shall be square at its four corners, twelve cubits long and twelve cubits wide. [17] "The ledge shall also be square, fourteen cubits long and fourteen cubits wide, with a rim of half a cubit and a gutter of a cubit all around it. The steps of the altar shall face east."

[18] Then He said to me: "Son of man, this is what the Lord GOD says: 'These are the statutes for the altar on the day it is constructed, so that burnt offerings may be sacrificed on it and blood may be sprinkled on it:'" [19] You are to give a young bull from the herd as a sin offering to the Levitical priests who are of the family of Zadok, who approach Me to minister before Me, declares the Lord GOD. [20] You are to take some of its blood and put it on the four horns of the altar, on the four corners of the ledge, and all around the rim; thus you will cleanse the altar and make atonement for it. [21] Then you are to take away the bull for the sin offering and burn it in the appointed part of the temple area outside the sanctuary. [22] On the second day you are to present an unblemished male goat as a sin offering, and the altar is to be cleansed as it was with the bull. [23] When you have finished the purification, you are to present a young, unblemished bull and an unblemished ram from the flock. [24] You must present them before the LORD; the priests are to sprinkle salt on them and sacrifice them as a burnt offering to the LORD. [25] For seven days you are to provide a male goat daily for a sin offering; you are also to provide a young bull and a ram from the flock, both unblemished. [26] For seven days the priests are to make atonement for the altar and cleanse it; so they shall consecrate it. [27] "At the end of these days, from the eighth day on, the priests are to present your burnt offerings and peace offerings on the altar. Then I will accept you, declares the Lord GOD.'"

44 The man then brought me back to the outer gate of the sanctuary that faced east, but it was shut. [2] And the LORD said to me, "This gate is to remain shut. It shall not be opened, and no man shall enter through it, because the LORD, the God of Israel, has entered through it. Therefore it will remain shut." [3] "Only the prince himself may sit inside the gateway to eat in the presence of the LORD. He must enter by way of the portico of the gateway and go out the same way." [4] Then the man brought me to the front of the temple by way of the north gate. I looked and saw the glory of the LORD filling His temple, and I fell facedown. [5] The LORD said to me: "Son of man, pay attention; look carefully with your eyes and listen closely with your ears to everything I tell you concerning all the statutes and laws of the house of the LORD. Take careful note of the entrance to the temple, along with all the exits of the sanctuary." [6] Tell the rebellious house of Israel that this is what the Lord GOD says: 'I have had enough of all your abominations, O house of Israel.' [7] In addition to all your other abominations, you brought in foreigners uncircumcised in both heart and flesh to occupy My sanctuary; you defiled My temple when you offered My food—the fat and the blood; you broke My covenant. [8] And you have not kept charge of My holy things, but have appointed others to keep charge of My sanctuary for you.' [9] This is what the Lord GOD says: No foreigner uncircumcised in heart and flesh may enter My sanctuary—not even a foreigner who lives among the Israelites.

[10] Surely the Levites who wandered away from Me when Israel went astray, and who wandered away from Me after their idols, will bear the consequences of their iniquity. [11] Yet they shall be ministers in My sanctuary, having charge of the gates of the temple and ministering there. They shall slaughter the burnt offerings and other sacrifices for the people and stand before them to minister to them. [12] Because they ministered before their idols and became a stumbling block of iniquity to the house of Israel, therefore I swore with an uplifted hand concerning them that they would bear the consequences of their iniquity, declares the Lord GOD. [13] They must not approach Me to serve Me as priests or come near any of My holy things or the most holy things. They will bear the shame of the abominations they have committed.

[14] Yet I will appoint them to keep charge of all the work for the temple and everything to be done in it. [15] But the Levitical priests, who are descended from Zadok and who kept charge of My sanctuary when the Israelites went astray from Me, are to approach Me to minister before Me. They will stand before Me to offer Me fat and blood, declares the Lord GOD. [16] They alone shall enter My sanctuary and draw near to My table to minister before Me. They will keep My charge. [17] When they enter the gates of the inner court, they are to wear linen garments; they must not wear anything made of wool when they minister at the gates of the inner court or inside the temple. [18] They are to wear linen turbans on their heads and linen undergarments around their waists. They must not wear anything that makes them perspire. [19] When they go out to the outer court, to the people, they are to take off the garments in which they have ministered, leave them in the holy chambers, and dress in other clothes so that they do not transmit holiness to the people with their garments.

[20] They must not shave their heads or let their hair grow long, but must carefully trim their hair. [21] No priest may drink wine before he enters the inner court. [22] And they shall not marry a widow or a divorced woman, but must marry a virgin of the descendants of the house of Israel, or a widow of a priest. [23] They are to teach My people the difference between the holy and the common, and show them how to discern between the clean and the unclean. [24] In any dispute, they shall officiate as judges and judge according to My ordinances. They must keep My laws and statutes regarding all My appointed feasts, and they must keep My Sabbaths holy. [25] A priest must not defile himself by going near a dead person. However, for a father, a mother, a son, a daughter, a brother, or an unmarried sister, he may do so, [26] and after he is cleansed, he must count off seven days for himself. [27] And on the day he goes into the sanctuary, into the inner court, to minister in the sanctuary, he must present his sin offering, declares the Lord GOD. [28] In regard to their inheritance, I am their inheritance. You are to give them no possession in Israel, for I am their possession. [29] They shall eat the grain offerings, the sin offerings, and the guilt offerings. Everything in Israel devoted to the LORD will belong to them. [30] The best of all the firstfruits and of every contribution from all your offerings will belong to the priests. You are to give your first batch of dough to the priest, so that a blessing may rest upon your homes. [31] The priests may not eat any bird or animal found dead or torn by wild beasts.

45 "When you divide the land by lot as an inheritance, you are to set aside a portion for the LORD, a holy portion of the land 25,000 cubits long and 20,000 cubits wide. This entire tract of land will be holy." [2] Within this area there is to be a section for the sanctuary 500 cubits square, with 50 cubits around it for open land. [3] From this holy portion, you are to measure off a length of 25,000 cubits and a width of 10,000 cubits, and in it will be the sanctuary, the Most

Holy Place. [4] It will be a holy portion of the land to be used by the priests who minister in the sanctuary, who draw near to minister before the LORD. It will be a place for their houses, as well as a holy area for the sanctuary. [5] An adjacent area 25,000 cubits long and 10,000 cubits wide shall belong to the Levites who minister in the temple; it will be their possession for towns in which to live. [6] As the property of the city, you are to set aside an area 5,000 cubits wide and 25,000 cubits long, adjacent to the holy district. It will belong to the whole house of Israel. [7] Now the prince will have the area bordering each side of the area formed by the holy district and the property of the city, extending westward from the western side and eastward from the eastern side, running lengthwise from the western boundary to the eastern boundary and parallel to one of the tribal portions.

[8] This land will be his possession in Israel. And My princes will no longer oppress My people, but will give the rest of the land to the house of Israel according to their tribes. [9] For this is what the Lord GOD says: 'Enough, O princes of Israel! Cease your violence and oppression, and do what is just and right. Stop dispossessing My people, declares the Lord GOD.' [10] You must use honest scales, a just ephah, and a just bath. [11] The ephah and the bath shall be the same quantity so that the bath will contain a tenth of a homer, and the ephah a tenth of a homer; the homer will be the standard measure for both. [12] The shekel will consist of twenty gerahs. Twenty shekels plus twenty-five shekels plus fifteen shekels will equal one mina. [13] This is the contribution you are to offer: a sixth of an ephah from each homer of wheat, and a sixth of an ephah from each homer of barley. [14] The prescribed portion of oil, measured by the bath, is a tenth of a bath from each cor (a cor consists of ten baths or one homer, since ten baths are equivalent to a homer). [15] And one sheep shall be given from each flock of two hundred from the well-watered pastures of Israel. These are for the grain offerings, burnt offerings, and peace offerings, to make atonement for the people, declares the Lord GOD.

[16] All the people of the land must participate in this contribution for the prince in Israel. [17] And it shall be the prince's part to provide the burnt offerings, grain offerings, and drink offerings for the feasts, New Moons, and Sabbaths—for all the appointed feasts of the house of Israel. He will provide the sin offerings, grain offerings, burnt offerings, and peace offerings to make atonement for the house of Israel.

[18] This is what the Lord GOD says: 'On the first day of the first month you are to take a young bull without blemish and purify the sanctuary.' [19] And the priest is to take some of the blood from the sin offering and put it on the doorposts of the temple, on the four corners of the ledge of the altar, and on the gateposts of the inner court. [20] You must do the same thing on the seventh day of the month for anyone who strays unintentionally or in ignorance. In this way you will make atonement for the temple. [21] On the fourteenth day of the first month you are to observe the Passover, a feast of seven days, during which unleavened bread shall be eaten. [22] On that day the prince shall provide a bull as a sin offering for himself and for all the people of the land. [23] Each day during the seven days of the feast, he shall provide seven bulls and seven rams without blemish as a burnt offering to the LORD, along with a male goat for a sin offering. [24] He shall also provide as a grain offering an ephah for each bull and an ephah for each ram, along with a hin of olive oil for each ephah of grain. [25] During the seven days of the feast that begins on the fifteenth day of the seventh month, he is to make the same provision for sin offerings, burnt offerings, grain offerings, and oil.'

46 "This is what the Lord GOD says: 'The gate of the inner court that faces east must be kept shut during the six days of work, but on the Sabbath day and on the day of the New Moon it shall be opened.'" [2] The prince is to enter from the outside through the portico of the gateway and stand by the gatepost, while the priests sacrifice his burnt offerings and peace offerings. He is to bow in worship at the threshold of the gate and then depart, but the gate must not be shut until evening. [3] On the Sabbaths and New Moons the people of the land are also to bow in worship before the LORD at the entrance to that gateway. [4] The burnt offering that the prince presents to the LORD on the Sabbath day shall be six unblemished male lambs and an unblemished ram. [5] The grain offering with the ram shall be one ephah, and the grain offering with the lambs shall be as much as he is able, along with a hin of oil per ephah. [6] On the day of the New Moon he shall offer a young, unblemished bull, six lambs, and a ram without blemish. [7] He is to provide a grain offering of an ephah with the bull, an ephah with the ram, and as much as he is able with the lambs, along with a hin of oil per ephah.

[8] When the prince enters, he shall go in through the portico of the gateway, and he shall go out the same way. [9] When the people of the land come before the LORD at the appointed feasts, whoever enters by the north gate to worship must go out by the south gate, and whoever enters by the south gate must go out by the north gate. No one is to return through the gate by which he entered, but each must go out by the opposite gate. [10] When the people enter, the prince shall go in with them, and when they leave, he shall leave. [11] At the festivals and appointed feasts, the grain offering shall be an ephah with a bull, an ephah with a ram, and as much as one is able to give with the lambs, along with a hin of oil per ephah. [12] When the prince makes a freewill offering to the LORD, whether a burnt offering or a peace offering, the gate facing east must be opened for him. He is to offer his burnt offering or peace offering just as he does on the Sabbath day. Then he shall go out, and the gate must be closed after he goes out. [13] And you shall provide an unblemished year-old lamb as a daily burnt offering to the LORD; you are to offer it every morning. [14] You are also to provide with it every morning a grain offering of a sixth of an ephah with a third of a hin of oil to moisten the fine flour—a grain offering to the LORD. This is a permanent statute. [15] Thus they shall provide the lamb, the grain offering, and the oil every morning as a regular burnt offering.'

[16] This is what the Lord GOD says: 'If the prince gives a gift to any of his sons as an inheritance, it will belong to his descendants. It will become their property by inheritance.' [17] But if he gives a gift from his inheritance to one of his servants, it will belong to that servant until the year of freedom; then it will revert to the prince. His inheritance belongs only to his sons; it shall be theirs. [18] "The prince must not take any of the inheritance of the people by evicting them from their property. He is to provide an inheritance for his sons from his own property, so that none of My people will be displaced from his property.'" [19] Then the man brought me through the entrance at the side of the gate into the holy chambers facing north, which belonged to the priests, and he showed me a place there at the far western end [20] and said to me, "This is the place where the priests shall boil the guilt offering and the sin offering, and where they shall bake the grain offering, so that they do not bring them into the outer court and transmit holiness to the people." [21] Then he brought me into the outer court and led me around to its four corners, and I saw a separate court in each of its corners. [22] In the four corners of the outer court there were enclosed courts, each forty cubits long and thirty cubits wide. Each of the four corner areas had the same dimensions. [23] Around the inside of each of the four courts was a row of masonry with ovens built at the base of the walls on all sides. [24] And he said to me, "These are the kitchens where those who minister at the temple will cook the sacrifices offered by the people."

47 Then the man brought me back to the entrance of the temple, and I saw water flowing from under the threshold of the temple toward the east (for the temple faced east). The water was coming down from under the south side of the temple, south of the altar. [2] Next he brought me out through the north gate and led me around the outside to the outer gate facing east, and there I saw the water trickling out from the south side. [3] As the man went eastward with a measuring line in his hand, he measured off a thousand cubits and led me through ankle-deep water. [4] Then he measured off a thousand cubits and led me through knee-deep water. Again he measured a thousand cubits and led me through waist-deep water. [5] Once again he measured off a thousand cubits, but now it was a river that I could not cross, because the water had risen and was deep enough for swimming—a river that could not be crossed on foot. [6] "Son of man, do you see this?" he asked. Then he led me back to the bank of the river.

[7] When I arrived, I saw a great number of trees along both banks of the river. [8] And he said to me, "This water flows out to the eastern region and goes down into the Arabah. When it empties into the Sea, the water there becomes fresh." [9] Wherever the river flows, there will be swarms of living creatures and a great number of fish, because it flows there and makes the waters fresh; so wherever the river flows, everything will flourish. [10] Fishermen will stand by the shore; from En-gedi to En-eglaim they will spread their nets to catch fish of many kinds, like the fish of the Great Sea. [11] But the swamps and marshes will not become fresh; they will be left for salt. [12] "Along both banks of the river, fruit trees of all kinds will grow. Their leaves will not wither, and their fruit will not fail. Each month they will bear fruit, because the water from the sanctuary flows to them. Their fruit will be used for food and their leaves for healing."

[13] This is what the Lord GOD says: "These are the boundaries by which you are to divide the land as an inheritance among the twelve tribes of Israel; Joseph shall receive two portions." [14] You are to divide it equally among them. Because I swore with an uplifted hand to give it to your forefathers, this land will fall to you as an inheritance.

[15] This shall be the boundary of the land: [16] On the north side it will extend from the Great Sea by way of Hethlon through Lebo-hamath to Zedad, Berothah, and Sibraim (which is on the border between Damascus and Hamath), as far as Hazer-hatticon, which is on the border of Hauran. [17] So the border will run from the Sea to Hazar-enan, along the northern border of Damascus, with the territory of Hamath to the north. This will be the northern boundary. [18] On the east side the border will run between Hauran and Damascus, along the Jordan between Gilead and the land of Israel, to the Eastern Sea and as far as Tamar. This will be the eastern boundary. [19] On the south side it will run from Tamar to the waters of Meribath-kadesh, and along the Brook of Egypt to the Great Sea. This will be the southern boundary. [20] And on the west side, the Great Sea will be the boundary up to a point opposite Lebo-hamath. This will be the western boundary. [21] You are to divide this land among yourselves according to the tribes of Israel. [22] You shall allot it as an inheritance for yourselves and for the foreigners who dwell among you and who have children. You are to treat them as native-born Israelites; along with you, they shall be allotted an inheritance among the tribes of Israel. [23] "In whatever tribe a foreigner dwells, you are to assign his inheritance there," declares the Lord GOD.

48 "Now these are the names of the tribes: At the northern frontier, Dan will have one portion bordering the road of Hethlon to Lebo-hamath and running on to Hazar-enan on the border of Damascus with Hamath to the north, and extending from the east side to the west side." [2] Asher will have one portion bordering the territory of Dan from east to west. [3] Naphtali will have one portion bordering the territory of Asher from east to west. [4] Manasseh will have one

portion bordering the territory of Naphtali from east to west. [5] Ephraim will have one portion bordering the territory of Manasseh from east to west. [6] Reuben will have one portion bordering the territory of Ephraim from east to west. [7] Judah will have one portion bordering the territory of Reuben from east to west. [8] Bordering the territory of Judah, from east to west, will be the portion you are to set apart. It will be 25,000 cubits wide and the length of a tribal portion from east to west. In the center will be the sanctuary. [9] The special portion you set apart to the LORD shall be 25,000 cubits long and 10,000 cubits wide. [10] This will be the holy portion for the priests. It will be 25,000 cubits long on the north side, 10,000 cubits wide on the west side, 10,000 cubits wide on the east side, and 25,000 cubits long on the south side. In the center will be the sanctuary of the LORD.

[11] It will be for the consecrated priests, the descendants of Zadok, who kept My charge and did not go astray as the Levites did when the Israelites went astray. [12] It will be a special portion for them set apart from the land, a most holy portion adjacent to the territory of the Levites. [13] Bordering the territory of the priests, the Levites shall have an area 25,000 cubits long and 10,000 cubits wide. The whole length will be 25,000 cubits, and the width 10,000 cubits. [14] They must not sell or exchange any of it, and they must not transfer this best part of the land, for it is holy to the LORD. [15] The remaining area, 5,000 cubits wide and 25,000 cubits long, will be for common use by the city, for houses, and for pastureland. The city will be in the center of it

[16] and will have these measurements: 4,500 cubits on the north side, 4,500 cubits on the south side, 4,500 cubits on the east side, and 4,500 cubits on the west side. [17] The pastureland of the city will extend 250 cubits to the north, 250 cubits to the south, 250 cubits to the east, and 250 cubits to the west. [18] The remainder of the length bordering the holy portion and running adjacent to it will be 10,000 cubits on the east side and 10,000 cubits on the west side. Its produce will supply food for the workers of the city. [19] The workers of the city who cultivate it will come from all the tribes of Israel. [20] The entire portion will be a square, 25,000 cubits by 25,000 cubits. You are to set apart the holy portion, along with the city property. [21] The remaining area on both sides of the holy portion and of the property of the city will belong to the prince. He will own the land adjacent to the tribal portions, extending eastward from the 25,000 cubits of the holy district toward the eastern border, and westward from the 25,000 cubits to the western border. And in the center of them will be the holy portion and the sanctuary of the temple. [22] So the Levitical property and the city property will lie in the center of the area belonging to the prince—the area between the borders of Judah and Benjamin.

[23] As for the rest of the tribes: Benjamin will have one portion extending from the east side to the west side. [24] Simeon will have one portion bordering the territory of Benjamin from east to west. [25] Issachar will have one portion bordering the territory of Simeon from east to west. [26] Zebulun will have one portion bordering the territory of Issachar from east to west. [27] And Gad will have one portion bordering the territory of Zebulun from east to west. [28] The southern border of Gad will run from Tamar to the waters of Meribath-kadesh, then along the Brook of Egypt and out to the Great Sea. [29] "This is the land you are to allot as an inheritance to the tribes of Israel, and these will be their portions," declares the Lord GOD. [30] "These will be the exits of the city:" [31] Beginning on the north side, which will be 4,500 cubits long, the gates of the city will be named after the tribes of Israel. On the north side there will be three gates: the gate of Reuben, the gate of Judah, and the gate of Levi. [32] On the east side, which will be 4,500 cubits long, there will be three gates: the gate of Joseph, the gate of Benjamin, and the gate of Dan. [33] On the south side, which will be 4,500 cubits long, there will be three gates: the gate of Simeon, the gate of Issachar, and the gate of Zebulun. [34] And on the west side, which will be 4,500 cubits long, there will be three gates: the gate of Gad, the gate of Asher, and the gate of Naphtali. [35] "The perimeter of the city will be 18,000 cubits, and from that day on the name of the city will be: THE LORD IS THERE."